Hollister Inc.

Overview

In Libertyville, **Hollister** refers to **Hollister Incorporated**, a major global healthcare company. Hollister Incorporated has been a staple of the Libertyville business community since moving its headquarters there from Chicago in 1982.

Corporate Overview

- **Mission:** A MedTech leader specializing in the development, manufacturing, and marketing of healthcare products, specifically focusing on **ostomy care**, **continence care**, and **critical care** (wound care).
- **Ownership:** It is an independent, **employee-owned** company, which is a significant part of its corporate identity and culture.
- **Global Reach:** While headquartered in Libertyville, the company serves customers in over 90 countries and maintains manufacturing and distribution facilities on three continents (including plants in Missouri, Virginia, Ireland, and Lithuania).

Libertyville Headquarters

The Libertyville campus serves as the global nerve center for the organization.

- **Location:** 2000 Hollister Drive, Libertyville, IL 60048. The campus is notably situated along the banks of the Des Plaines River.
- **Local Impact:** The headquarters houses over **500 employees** (referred to as "associates") across various global functions, including R&D, corporate accounting, and strategic communications.
- **Community Roots:** The company was founded in 1921 by John Dickinson Schneider and is built on four "Immutable Principles": Dignity of the Person, Service, Integrity, and Stewardship.

Product Focus

If you are looking for specific services or products associated with this location, they are primarily medical supplies:

- **CeraPlus™:** A well-known line of skin barriers for ostomy care.
- **VaPro™:** Their primary brand of intermittent catheters.
- **Secure Start™ Services:** A personalized support program offered to patients regardless of the brand of products they use.

In 2026, Hollister Incorporated is undergoing a significant strategic pivot toward **digital transformation** and **expanded patient access**, while maintaining its core leadership in MedTech.

As an employee-owned company, their 2026 roadmap is heavily focused on long-term sustainability and advocacy rather than short-term shareholder returns.

1. Core Products & Service Lines

Hollister remains anchored in three primary medical categories, with a 2026 focus on "skin health" as a competitive differentiator.

Ostomy Care

- **CeraPlus™ Portfolio:** Their flagship line of skin barriers and pouches. In 2026, they are expanding the use of **Ceramide-infused technology** (Remois technology) across more product variants to prevent peristomal skin complications before they start.
- **Convexity Solutions:** Advanced soft convex options designed to fit uneven body contours, reducing the risk of leakage for complex stomas.

Continence Care

- **VaPro™ Intermittent Catheters:** Features "100% No Touch Protection" to reduce UTIs. 2026 sees a push for **VaPro Plus Pocket** versions for discreet, on-the-go use.
- **Infyna Chic™:** A female-focused catheter designed for discretion and aesthetic appeal, aiming to reduce the "medical" feel of the device.

Critical Care & Wound Care

- **AnchorFast™:** The market leader in oral endotracheal tube fasteners, used in ICUs to prevent skin breakdown around the mouth.
- **Hydrofera Blue®:** Specialized antibacterial foam dressings for complex wound management.

Hollister Secure Start™ Services

This is their primary **service offering**. It is a brand-neutral, no-cost support program that provides users with:

- Direct access to specialized nurses and advisors.

- Insurance navigation and supplier matching.
- Long-term lifestyle and educational resources.

2. Strategic Priorities for 2026

Current corporate initiatives reflect a blend of global manufacturing upgrades and aggressive patient advocacy.

Digital Transformation & R&D Expansion

Hollister is in the midst of a multi-year **€80 million investment** (notably in their Ballina and Lithuania sites) to digitize their manufacturing and R&D.

- **Goal:** Transforming manufacturing plants into "global epicenters of expertise" using AI-driven device design and site-wide digital training.
- **Impact:** Expect more "smart" product features and faster cycles for custom-fit medical solutions.

Expanded Patient Access (The "SCI Victory")

A major 2026 priority is capitalizing on a landmark policy win for **Spinal Cord Injury (SCI)** patients.

- **Strategic Shift:** Effective **January 1, 2026**, Medicare expanded coverage for "closed system" catheters (like VaPro) for all SCI patients.
- **Execution:** Hollister is prioritizing the conversion of Medicare beneficiaries to these safer, closed-system devices to reduce systemic UTI rates.

Institutional Partnerships

Hollister recently renewed major three-year agreements with **Premier, Inc.** (effective April 2026).

- **Priority:** Securing "sole source" or "preferred" status in Group Purchasing Organizations (GPOs) to ensure their products are the standard of care in major U.S. hospital networks.

Sustainability & Environmental Goals

The company has set aggressive 2026-aligned targets in their latest Sustainability Report:

- **Target:** A 25% reduction in Scope 3 emissions by 2030, with 2026 serving as a critical audit year for their global supply chain.
- **Operations:** Increased reliance on on-site solar and renewable energy certificates at their larger manufacturing facilities.

Hollister Incorporated's digital transformation and R&D expansion are currently centered on a multi-year, multi-million dollar strategy to move from a legacy "analog" manufacturing model to a **digitally native MedTech ecosystem**.

By 2026, these efforts are maturing into a "Global Epicenter" model, where individual manufacturing sites serve as specialized hubs for innovation rather than just high-volume production lines.

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1. The Digital Transformation Strategy

Hollister's digital shift is focused on three key areas: **Operational Intelligence**, **Regulatory Digitization**, and **Patient Engagement**.

Operational Intelligence: The Hollister Production System (HPS)

Hollister has implemented a standardized, lean-based digital backbone across its global sites.

- **Real-time Analytics:** Transitioning from manual, paper-based reporting to automated data collection on the factory floor. This allows managers to identify bottlenecks or quality deviations in seconds rather than days.
- **Predictive Maintenance:** Utilizing IoT (Internet of Things) sensors on production machinery to predict when components will fail, reducing downtime for critical products like the **VaPro™** catheters.

Regulatory Digitization: Stability Management Systems

A major milestone reached in early 2026 is the completion of the "Paper to Digital" transition for product stability programs.

- **What it means:** Historically, testing how medical devices age (stability testing) involved massive paper trails.

- **The 2026 Impact:** Hollister now uses a validated **Stability-LIMS (Laboratory Information Management System)**. This has increased operational efficiency by 20% and ensures "bulletproof" data integrity for FDA and EU regulatory audits.
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Digital Patient Support

- **Secure Start™ Digital Portal:** Expansion of the Secure Start service into a more robust digital health platform. By 2026, this includes more self-service educational modules, virtual nurse consultations, and digital "stoma-checks" to help patients manage their care from home.

2. Global R&D Expansion & "Epicenters"

Rather than centralizing all R&D in Libertyville, Hollister is investing heavily in regional centers of excellence to tap into local talent and specialized tech.

The Ballina, Ireland Expansion (€80M Investment)

As of 2025–2026, the Ballina site has officially transitioned into a **"Global Epicenter of Expertise."**

- **Focus:** Advanced device design and automation.
- **Talent:** The investment added 50 high-tech roles in **Data Science, Engineering, and R&D**.
- **Technology:** The site now benchmarks "best-in-class" digital manufacturing for the entire Hollister network, serving as the testing ground for new automated assembly technologies before they are rolled out to the US or Lithuania.

The Kaunas, Lithuania Hub

The Lithuania facility has expanded beyond its initial 2019 footprint to become a secondary R&D pillar.

- **Primary Function:** High-complexity manufacturing for the European market.
- **2026 Priority:** Developing regional variations of the **CeraPlus™** line and expanding the production of specialized continence care products to meet growing European demand.

3. Strategic R&D Pillars for 2026

Hollister’s R&D efforts are currently concentrated on two "Next-Gen" technological goals:

Pillar	R&D Objective	Target Outcome
Skin Science	Integrating advanced biomaterials (Ceramides) deeper into the adhesive barriers.	Reduction in Peristomal Skin Complications (PSC).
Closed-System Tech	Enhancing the "No-Touch" mechanics of catheters.	Drastic reduction in hospital-acquired UTIs, aligning with 2026 Medicare policy shifts.

digitally native MedTech ecosystem" is no longer a buzzword—it is a fully operational business model that integrates **digital manufacturing**, **regulatory data**, and **direct-to-patient support** into a single, unified loop.

Here is how this ecosystem functions across their three core pillars:

1. Digital Manufacturing: "The Epicenter Model"

Hollister has moved away from "batch" manufacturing in favor of a connected factory model, largely driven by their **€80 million investment** in sites like Ballina, Ireland.

- **AI-Driven Production:** Factories now utilize **automated data collection** and **real-time analytics**. This allows the Libertyville HQ to monitor production quality in European plants instantly, reducing waste and ensuring that products like the CeraPlus barriers are perfectly consistent.
- **Predictive Maintenance:** IoT sensors on production lines predict machine failures before they happen, ensuring the global supply of critical medical devices —like catheters—remains uninterrupted.

2. Regulatory Digitization: Stability-LIMS

A major part of being "digitally native" is how the company handles the massive amount of data required by the FDA and global regulators.

- **Paper-to-Digital Leap:** By early 2026, Hollister successfully transitioned from fragmented paper workflows to a **Stability-LIMS (Laboratory Information Management System)**.
- **Compliance Efficiency:** This system automates "pull schedules" for product testing and uses built-in statistical modeling for shelf-life projections.
- **The Result:** A **20% increase in operational efficiency**, allowing R&D teams to spend more time on actual innovation rather than manual data entry and audit preparation.

3. The Patient-Care Loop: Secure Start℠

The ecosystem extends beyond the factory and into the user's home, creating a "closed-loop" relationship between the manufacturer and the patient.

- **Digital Support Portal:** The **Secure Start℠** platform now serves as a digital health hub. In 2026, it provides virtual nurse consultations and digital "stoma-checks," allowing patients to manage their chronic conditions with fewer hospital visits.

- **Data-Driven Feedback:** Anonymous data from these patient interactions informs R&D. If patients consistently report a specific comfort issue through the digital portal, that data is fed directly back into the design phase for the next generation of products.

Strategic Comparison: The "Ecosystem" Shift

Legacy MedTech Model	2026 Digitally Native Ecosystem
Reactive: Fixes problems after they occur.	**Predictive:** Uses AI to prevent manufacturing and skin-health issues.
Siloed: R&D, Manufacturing, and Sales are separate.	**Integrated:** Data flows seamlessly between the factory floor and the patient.
Paper-Heavy: Compliance is a manual, slow process.	**Digital-First:** Stability and regulatory data are automated and real-time.

Core Technology Planning

architecture and implementation strategy for a "thinking factory" in medical device manufacturing, utilizing **Critical Manufacturing MES** as the digital backbone.

1. MES Strategy: Critical Manufacturing & gMFG Principles

In the context of medical devices, **gMFG (Global Manufacturing)** principles emphasize standardized, high-precision operations that remain compliant across international borders.

- Standardization via CoE - global baseline, replicable blueprints, unified lifecycle
- Digital Integrity & Compliance (golden record) - SSOT for 2026 QMSR (Quality Management System Regulation), electronic enforcement, validated data flow, audit readiness
- Operational Agility & Intelligence - RT visibility, predictive scaling (using AI and predictive analytics to identify performance trends), vendor & resource optimization
- Cultural & Skill Transformation - standardization requires workforce training on global best practices, team development, cross-functional synergy, bridge the gap between global IT, quality, engineering, and local manufacturing leaders to deliver integrated digital solutions

Core MES Capabilities

- **Modular Automation:** Critical Manufacturing uses a rule-based dynamic workflow engine to integrate with IIoT devices and enterprise systems seamlessly.
- **Digital Accelerators:** Features like a **Unified Namespace (UNS)** and a **Collaboration Hub** ensure that data flows without silos across the entire plant.
- **Tech Transfer Efficiency:** For medical devices, tech transfer (moving a design from R&D to production) is accelerated by building work instructions and flow structures digitally. One implementation reduced this setup time from 20 hours over months to just five hours in a single day.

Applying gMFG Principles

- **Clear Roles (Principle 1):** Use the MES to establish a chain of accountability for every task.
- **Staff Development (Principle 2):** Integrate eQMS training records directly into the MES. The system can prevent an operator from starting a task if their certification has expired.
- **Electronic Records (Principle 5):** The "If it’s not written down, it didn't happen" rule is automated through digital signatures and time-stamped **Electronic Batch Records (EBR)**.

2. SAP Integration: ERP & WMS

The integration creates a "closed loop" where the ERP handles the "what and when" (planning) while the MES handles the "how" (execution).

- **ERP (SAP S4/HANA):** Manages production orders, master data, and global procurement.
- **WMS Integration:** MES tracks real-time material usage on the shop floor and instantly updates the WMS to trigger restocking or procurement.
- **Closed-Loop Synchronization:**
    - **Phase 1:** SAP sends a production order to Critical Manufacturing MES.
    - **Phase 2:** MES executes the order, tracking every component used.
    - **Phase 3:** MES feeds quality and completion data back to SAP for financial and compliance reporting.

3. AI: Visual Inspection & Real-Time Analytics

Integrating AI with MES allows for a shift from reactive to **predictive** quality management.

AI Visual Inspection

- **Computer Vision (e.g., YOLO11):** Used to detect defects, confirm component placement, and automate pass/fail sorting that rule-based systems might miss.
- **Advanced Detection:** AI models can be trained on thousands of samples to identify minute variations in packaging or product surfaces, even on curved or low-contrast items.

Real-Time Analytics

- **Predictive Maintenance:** AI analyzes sensor data to predict equipment failures, which can reduce unplanned downtime by up to **52%**.
- **First-Pass Quality:** Real-time process monitoring has been shown to improve first-pass quality by roughly **32%**.

4. Regulatory Standards: QMSR and ISO 13485

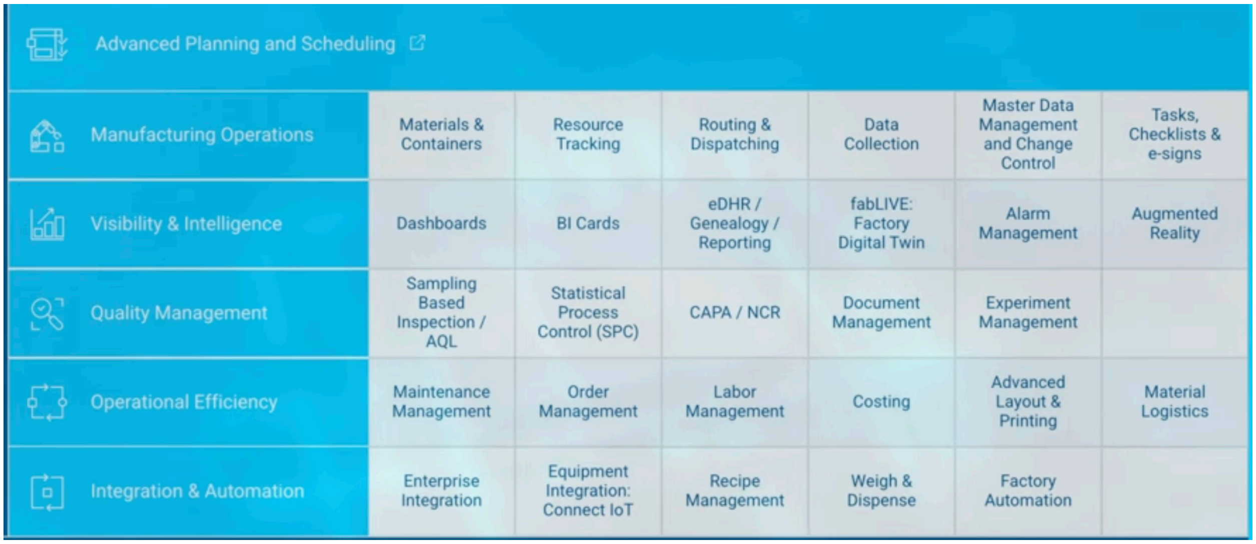
Effective **February 2, 2026**, the FDA's **Quality Management System Regulation (QMSR)** replaces the old QSR, harmonizing US regulations with **ISO 13485:2016**.

- **Risk-Based Approach:** QMSR mandates a risk-based approach throughout the entire product lifecycle.
- **Terminology Shift:** Digital systems must update their language. For example, the **Medical Device File (MDF)** now replaces the Device Master Record (DMR) and Device History Record (DHR).
- **Validation Requirements:** ISO 13485 strictly requires validation for any process that cannot be verified by subsequent inspection (e.g., sterilization or complex software workflows).

5. IIoT and RPA: The Fully Autonomous Factory

- **IIoT (Industrial IoT):** Connected sensors provide a continuous data stream, creating a **Digital Twin** of the facility to test hardware and software virtually before physical deployment.
- **RPA (Robotic Process Automation):** RPA handles manual, repetitive administrative tasks—such as logging data into multiple systems—minimizing human error and freeing staff for strategic roles.
- **Strategic Outcome:** This combination leads to "compliance by default," where every step of production is automatically logged, creating a fully traceable electronic trail for audits.

MES Breakdown



Advanced Planning and Scheduling						
Manufacturing Operations	Materials & Containers	Resource Tracking	Routing & Dispatching	Data Collection	Master Data Management and Change Control	Tasks, Checklists & e-signs
Visibility & Intelligence	Dashboards	BI Cards	eDHR / Genealogy / Reporting	fabLIVE: Factory Digital Twin	Alarm Management	Augmented Reality
Quality Management	Sampling Based Inspection / AQL	Statistical Process Control (SPC)	CAPA / NCR	Document Management	Experiment Management	
Operational Efficiency	Maintenance Management	Order Management	Labor Management	Costing	Advanced Layout & Printing	Material Logistics
Integration & Automation	Enterprise Integration	Equipment Integration: Connect IoT	Recipe Management	Weigh & Dispense	Factory Automation	

- **Advanced Planning & Scheduling (APS)**
- **Manufacturing Operations**
  - Materials & Containers
  - Resource Tracking
  - Routing & Dispatch
  - Data Collection
  - MDM & Change Control
  - Tasks, Checklists, & E-Signs
- **Visibility & Intelligence**
  - Dashboards
  - BI Cards
  - eDHR (Electronic Device History Record)
    - **Real-Time Documentation:** It replaces traditional paper "travelers" by capturing data at every step of the production process, from material issuance to final inspection.

- **Compliance Enforcement:** An MES (like Critical Manufacturing) uses eDHR to prevent "out-of-order" processing; for example, a unit cannot move to packaging if it hasn't passed the AI visual inspection step.
- **Error Reduction:** It eliminates common manual errors such as missing signatures, illegible handwriting, or incorrect dates, ensuring the system is always "audit-ready" for FDA or ISO inspections.

- Genealogy (complete history of all components and environments during build)
  - **Component tracking**
  - **Process Linkage** (machine, operator, software version used during mfg)
  - **Targeted Recalls** (surgical recall on which components and units impacted for batches and production lots)
- Reporting & Analytics
  - Operational visibility (using Power BI or SAP S4/Hana) to monitor RT KPIs (yield rates, throughput, equipment downtime)
  - Predictive Intelligence - Spot trends using AI before they become failures, machine calibration, metrology, parts and inventory defects
  - Regulatory Reviews - generate STD report for mgmt and compliance documentation, proving gMFG, processes are in state of control (ISO:13485)
- Factory Digital Twin - **real-time 3D virtual window** into the shop floor
  - Virtual Window - 3D Real Time View
    - Interactive Status Tracking (Green, Yellow, Red)
    - Drag & Drop Mapping to create & modify the Digital Twin
  - Integrative Intelligence
    - IIoT Connectivity - critical manufacturing connect IoT platform used to ingest data from all sensors & actuators to ensure the Twin mirrors reality
    - Contextualized KPIs - click on any piece of equipment to get dashboards and metrics for that equipment (OEE, uptime history, MTBF)
    - Self-Healing Capabilities - resource allocation, adjust production flows in real time to mitigate downtime

    - Benefits - Remote Observability, Simulation & Dry Runs, Standardization (part of a CoE) so we can promote a baseline MES across all sites
  - Alarm Management
  - Augmented Reality
- **Quality Management**
  - Sampling Based Inspection / AQL
  - Statistical Process Control (SPC)
  - CAPA / NCR - Corrective and Preventative Action / Non-Conformance Report
    - Detection - Visualization - System Action
    - Data Capture from machine sensor logs, current operator ID, timestamps, component genealogy
    - Classification using AI Analytics to categorize the Event (failure type / mode) and determine if it occurred previously
    - Escalation CAPA - RCA, investigation and Action Plan (resolution / resumption)
    - Verification & Closure (digital loop)
      - Effectiveness check, Audit Readiness (ISO:13485 or FDA Audit)
  - Document Management
  - Experiment Management
- **Operational Efficiency**
  - Maintenance management
  - Order Management
  - Labor Management
  - Costing
  - Advance Layout & Printing
  - Material Logistics
- **Integration & Automation**
  - Enterprise Integration
  - Equipment Integration: Connect to IoT
  - Recipe Management
  - Weigh & Dispense
  - Factory Automation

IoT Data Platform

This is the "nervous system" that feeds the fabLIVE 3D Digital Twin. Provides the underlying engine that supports data ingestion, transformations, cleansing, and contextualization from the shop floor (raw data feeds from devices and machines)

Core Components include:

Middleware - for pulling data from physical equipment and feeding to the MES. Translates signals from machines into meaningful data for consumption in MES

- Data Ingestion - PLC, smart sensors, torque drivers, cameras. Uses multiple protocols (OPC UA, MQTT, SEC/GEM)
- Contextualization - Attaches metadata so we know where the data came from (device, time, batch etc)
- Visual Output - status flags, colors, symbols
- Standardized Mapping (drag & drop source to target for building pipelines)
- Edge Processing - quality checks detecting failure modes by examining the data on each local device and trigger alerts within the MES before reaching the central server
- Integrated Workflow - services & workflow can be linked through events using triggers (event-based design)
- Line at a Glance Management - review all mfg lines across all sites in one place because the IoT drives data standardization across different tools and devices
- Predictive Intelligence - storing historical data from IoT supports AI Training to recognize patterns that precede machine breakdown, triggering proactive maintenance
- Regulatory Transparency - for FDA regulations, ensure that every “event” is timestamped, contextualized, and linked to the genealogy for every product that rolls of the line (supports ISO 13485 & QMSR)

Strategic Success Statements

Use these to answer questions like: "Tell us about a time you led a large-scale manufacturing project."

- **On Scaling Operations:** "I led the build-out of a $50M pharmaceutical facility from the ground up, specifically managing the transition from space planning to full-scale production.
- I can apply this experience to Hollister's Digital Factory initiatives by ensuring that the physical layout and the digital MES architecture (like **fabLIVE**) are perfectly synchronized for maximum throughput."
- **On Regulatory Compliance:** "During my leadership of the FDA submission process for a new facility, I ensured that every system met strict GMP standards.
- I am prepared to lead the 2026 transition to the **QMSR** standard at Hollister, leveraging my background in validated systems to ensure that our digital batch records are 'audit-ready' from day one."
- **On Cross-Functional Leadership:** "By overseeing capital spend and operations for a major launch, I learned how to bridge the gap between IT Finance, Engineering, and Quality.
- I will use this experience to build a **Center of Excellence** that doesn't just implement technology, but drives measurable business value and operational excellence."

Consolidated Interview Question List

I. Roadmap & Strategic Vision

1. Does the organization have a formal roadmap or blueprint for the digital transformation (encompassing the digital factory, intelligence, customer/patient-first, and institutional partnerships)?
2. How far along is the organization on this roadmap, and what are the specific high-priority milestones for 2026?
3. What is the current 'Template' status for the **Critical Manufacturing** rollout? Are we in the Global Blueprinting phase, or have we moved into Site-Specific Pilots?

II. Systems & Technology Implementation

4. How much of the Critical Manufacturing MES is currently implemented, and has the groundwork for the next phase of deployment begun?
5. The JD mentions 'Labeling Platforms' and 'Plant Maintenance' applications; to what extent will these be integrated into the MES heartbeat versus remaining as standalone satellite systems?
6. How is the team currently handling **Computer System Validation (CSV)** for AI and predictive models, especially considering the 2026 QMSR/ISO 13485 harmonization?

III. Architecture & Data Governance

7. Are there established architecture standards for data engineering, BI, and AI, including a Unified Namespace (UNS) to ensure a 'Single Source of Truth' across global sites?
8. What governance frameworks are in place to manage the intersection of AI, cybersecurity, and regulatory compliance?
9. How do we manage the data lifecycle between the shop floor (IIoT) and the enterprise layer (**SAP S/4HANA**)?

IV. Center of Excellence (CoE) & Change Management

10. Is there a CoE already in place for establishing the baseline MES for all manufacturing lines, or will building that structure be my first priority?

11. How much of the implementation is handled by internal 'Application Specialists' versus third-party system integrators or the vendor?
12. What is the current 'Digital Maturity' or appetite for change at the plant level, and what resources are available to help staff transition from paper-based to digital workflows?

- SAP - MES (Critical MFG)
- Ignition
- OPC server ==> for OEEE
- Data warehouse working with the AI team
- Machine Learning /
- Need to get a PLM installed for incremental releases
- How is MFG impacted by PLM
- Great company / not a lot of politics
- Arch / Infrastructure / Security
- Appetite to do everything
- New CTO = put breaks on PLM
- Need help to build the digital thread
- Still in design phase
- EUY / contractors working on strategy
- Logistics and pricing handled by SAP person
- Consistency and OEEE
- Cost Reductions working with OE & OT
- Just starting to pull signals from machines (sit down with OT/IT) collaboration
- Just hired an IT manager that will work with the OT manager

- Working through the Gartner / API abstraction
- PMO coordinated through / fail fast
- Bringing in ServiceNow (ticket management / SDLC)
  - From Chairwell (ITIL)
- Labeling systems
- Contract Manufacturing (R&D, PLM, Labeling)
- Feed recipes and final drafts
- Eboms and MBoms
- PLM & other pieces towards
- Data Quality / Data Investigations
- AI Data Analytics and RPA team
  - ABAP programming
  - AI experts
- MS Fabric & Co-Pilot 365
  - Use Cases and Business Value
  - Agentic AI
- New CIO rebuilt the entire organization
  - She understands all the tech issues (great person)
  - AMGEN, ABBOTT, people
  - Pulling in a team
- Head of Governance & Compliance in place
- Digital Factory & Digital Thread

Sylvia - IT sourcing

- Positioning
- In May 4 Days/week
- Contract to Hire vs W2
- She will Touch base with Dan
- Replace person who is retiring (Debbie)
  - Pain points with systems and/or people
  - Active Listening is key
- Talk with strategic partners in other depts. (Ireland)
- Establish a rapport with each site
  - Quarterly